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WITNESS STATEMENT — Dana Whitfield

Case #: 26-014872 **Witness:** Dana WHITFIELD, age 41 (bartender, Ramona's Sane Bar & Grill) **Taken by:** Det. R. Salas #207 **Date:** March 15, 2026, 0105 hrs **Format:** Q&A, summarized verbatim

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Q: Where were you when this started?

A: Behind the bar, right in the middle, where I always am. I had a clear look down the room most of the night. It was slow — maybe five, six people left.

Q: Did you know either man?

A: Daniel's a regular, comes in after work. Marcus I'd seen a few times. Marcus had been drinking and he was loud. He'd already gotten in somebody's face earlier.

Q: Tell me what you saw.

A: They were arguing near the bar and it moved back toward the pool table. I was watching because I didn't like Marcus's energy. Marcus went at Daniel — he closed the distance fast, he was the one moving forward. I saw his arm come up toward his belt, like he was reaching for his waistband. It happened really fast.

Q: Could you see Marcus's hands the whole time?

A: Not perfectly. It's darker over by the pool table — that light's been out. But I could see he was coming forward at Daniel, not backing up. He was the aggressor, no question in my mind.

Q: Then what?

A: Two shots, close together. It was over in a couple of seconds. Daniel didn't chase him or stand over him or anything. He kind of froze and then said to call 911.

Q: Did Daniel say anything before he fired?

A: There wasn’t time for a speech, if that’s what you mean. Marcus was on him and then it happened.

Q: Anything else?

A: Just that Marcus came at him. I keep replaying it. Marcus was the one moving in.

Statement read back and affirmed by witness.